

MassDwell Solutions — Global Sourcing Guide

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Prepared by Clawson | Confidential — Internal Use Only

Overview

This document outlines MassDwell's recommended direct-from-manufacturer sourcing strategy for ADU build components. The goal is to reduce COGS meaningfully by bypassing domestic distributors and establishing container-volume relationships with OEM manufacturers across four geographic regions.

Strategy Summary:

- Buy where the manufacturing actually happens, not where it's rebranded
- Diversify across geographies to reduce tariff exposure
- Time the first container orders for Q1 2027 (40-unit trajectory supports the volume)
- Build supplier relationships now; negotiate pricing before you need the inventory

Tariff & Lead Time Reference

Region	Tariff Status	Ocean Lead Time	Notes
China	Subject to Section 301 tariffs (7.5–25%+)	6–8 weeks	Volatile — build tariff buffer into COGS model
Vietnam	Lower tariffs, stable	5–7 weeks	Post-2018 tariff shift; mature US export relationships
Mexico	USMCA — 0% tariff	3–5 days (truck)	Best lead time; can visit factories
India	Low tariffs, stable	5–8 weeks	Best for premium fixtures; strong English comms

China — HVAC (Mini-Splits)

Why China: The only category where no other region competes on price at scale. Midea and Gree manufacture the units that are rebranded and sold by Carrier, Toshiba, Bosch, and dozens of US brands at 40–60% markup. ETL/UL certification is available from legitimate OEM factories.

COGS Impact: \$3,000–\$5,000 savings per unit vs. domestic wholesale pricing.

Volume note: At 28 units/year, mini-split volume is workable. At 40+ units (2027), savings compound significantly.

Suppliers

Supplier	Website	Notes
Midea Group	midea.com	World's largest HVAC manufacturer. OEM for Carrier, Toshiba, and others. Direct B2B export sales available. ETL-listed products.

		Start here.
Gree Electric	gree.com	Second largest globally. Makes units for Daikin in some markets. Highly negotiable at container volume.
AUX Air Conditioning	aux.com.cn	Tier 2 behind Midea/Gree. Sometimes better pricing on smaller initial orders. Good entry point.

How to Engage

- Contact via their export/B2B portals directly
- US-facing reps can be found at **AHR Expo** (annual HVAC trade show)
- Request ETL certification documentation upfront — legitimate factories will have it

Vietnam — Cabinets + LVP Flooring

Why Vietnam: The 2018 US–China tariff wave permanently shifted cabinet and LVP flooring sourcing to Vietnam. The manufacturing base is now mature, quality is comparable to China, and tariff exposure is dramatically lower. Home Depot, Floor & Decor, and major US retailers source here.

Cabinets

COGS Impact: RTA cabinet pricing from Vietnam is roughly 1/3 of domestic wholesale. For a 650 SF unit with a full kitchen and 1–2 baths, this represents \$4,000–\$8,000 in savings per unit at container scale.

Supplier	Website	Notes
An Cuong Wood Working JSC	ancuong.com	Vietnam's largest panel and cabinet manufacturer. Already exports to Home Depot and major US retailers. Plywood boxes, soft-close hardware, dovetail joints available. Best starting point.
AA Corporation	aacorporation.com.vn	Mid-size, flexible MOQs, strong English communication. Export-focused. Good for smaller initial orders.
Minh Long Furniture	minhlongfurniture.com	RTA-focused, US export experience, competitive on frameless euro-style boxes.

LVP Flooring

COGS Impact: Container pricing is roughly 1/3 of domestic wholesale. For ~700 SF per unit, savings of \$1,500–\$2,500 per unit at volume.

Supplier	Website	Notes
Wellmade	wellmadefloor.com	Major OEM — supplies Floor & Decor and major US distributors. Vietnam-manufactured. FloorScore certified. Best quality/price balance.
Dongwha Vietnam	—	Korean-owned, Vietnam-manufactured. Consistent quality, strong certifications. Good secondary option.

How to Engage

- An Cuong has an export division that handles direct B2B — contact via their website
- Request CARB Phase 2 compliance documentation for cabinets (required for California; good practice nationally)
- Request FloorScore or GreenGuard certification for flooring

Mexico — Plumbing Fixtures + Lighting

Why Mexico: USMCA means zero tariffs. Lead time is 3–5 days by truck vs. 6–8 weeks by ocean. You can physically visit factories without international travel. The landed cost math frequently beats China once you factor in tariffs and carrying costs on 6 months of ocean-freight inventory.

Plumbing Fixtures

COGS Impact: Domestic plumbing fixture markups are significant. Mexico-direct pricing at container volume typically saves \$1,500–\$3,000 per unit across the full fixtures package (faucets, showerheads, toilet, valves, hardware).

Supplier	Website	Notes
Helvex	helvex.com.mx	Mexico's dominant plumbing brand. Full product line: faucets, valves, showerheads, flush valves, supply lines. cUPC certified. Strong US export program. Best starting point.
Urrea	urrea.com	Larger catalog including valves, supply lines, and rough plumbing. Good pricing at volume. Has US distribution network.
American Standard Mexico	americanstandard.com	Same American Standard products, Mexico-manufactured, USMCA-eligible. Strong option for toilets specifically.

Lighting

COGS Impact: ETL-listed LED fixtures from Mexico at container pricing saves \$800–\$1,500 per unit across full lighting package (recessed cans, vanity fixtures, under-cabinet, exterior).

Supplier	Website	Notes
Leviton Mexico	leviton.com	Leviton manufactures in Monterrey. USMCA-eligible. Buy devices, dimmers, panels, and residential wiring devices direct. Same brand, fraction of domestic price.
Prolux	prolux.com.mx	Mexican LED manufacturer for commercial and residential. ETL equivalents available. Good for recessed cans and fixtures.

How to Engage

- Helvex and Urrea have US-facing sales teams — contact directly for distributor/OEM pricing
- Leviton Mexico: work through Leviton's commercial sales team and reference USMCA sourcing intent

- Factory visits are straightforward — Monterrey is a 3-hour direct flight from Boston

India — Plumbing Fixtures (Premium Tier)

Why India: Better design aesthetics than Mexico, competitive with China on price, and significantly lower tariff risk. Jaquar already sells into the US luxury market. Use India for the Dwell Deluxe and Dwell Prime models where finish quality matters more to the customer.

COGS Impact: Comparable to Mexico on pricing; stronger on design differentiation for premium models.

Supplier	Website	Notes
Jaquar Group	jaquar.com	India's export powerhouse for bathroom products. Full collections — faucets, showers, accessories, sanitaryware. Already in US luxury market. Can spec cUPC certification. Best quality.
Hindware (HSIL)	hindware.com	Strong on sanitaryware — toilets, sinks, vanities. More mass-market than Jaquar. Good value for Essential and Classic models.
Cera Sanitaryware	cera-india.com	Good value on toilets and vanities. Export program available. Reliable quality.

How to Engage

- Jaquar has a North America office — reach out via their website's commercial/export inquiry form
- Request cUPC or IAPMO certification documentation upfront
- Consider a tiered spec: Jaquar for Prime/Deluxe, Hindware for Classic/Essential

Recommended Sourcing Matrix

Component	Region	Primary Supplier	Tier
Mini-split HVAC	 China	Midea Group	All models
Kitchen cabinets	 Vietnam	An Cuong Wood Working	All models
LVP flooring	 Vietnam	Wellmade	All models
Plumbing fixtures (standard)	 Mexico	Helvex	Essential / Classic
Plumbing fixtures (premium)	 India	Jaquar Group	Deluxe / Prime
Lighting package	 Mexico	Leviton Mexico	All models

Estimated COGS Savings Per Unit (At Container Volume)

Category	Current Domestic Cost (Est.)	Direct-Source Cost (Est.)	Savings Per Unit
HVAC (mini-split)	\$4,500	\$1,800	~\$2,700

Cabinets	\$6,000	\$2,200	~\$3,800
LVP Flooring	\$3,500	\$1,200	~\$2,300
Plumbing fixtures	\$3,000	\$1,100	~\$1,900
Lighting package	\$1,800	\$700	~\$1,100
TOTAL	~\$18,800	~\$7,000	~\$11,800/unit

At 40 units/year (2027), this represents approximately **\$472,000 in annual COGS reduction** — roughly 6–7 percentage points of gross margin improvement on its own.

Implementation Timeline

Milestone	Target
Initiate supplier conversations (Midea, An Cuong, Helvex, Jaquar)	Q2 2026
Request samples + certifications	Q3 2026
Finalize specs per model (Essential/Classic/Deluxe/Prime)	Q3 2026
Negotiate container pricing & MOQs	Q4 2026
First container order	Q1 2027
Full direct-source program operational	Q2 2027

Notes & Risks

- **Tariff volatility (China):** Build a 15–20% tariff buffer into HVAC COGS model. Consider dual-sourcing HVAC from a secondary Vietnam or India manufacturer as backup.
- **Lead time inventory:** Ocean freight requires 6–8 week buffer stock. Plan warehouse space at Woonsocket accordingly.
- **Certification:** Always confirm ETL, cUPC, FloorScore, or CARB compliance before finalizing any supplier. Request documentation before placing any order.
- **MOQ management:** Start with smaller trial orders before committing to full containers. Most suppliers will accommodate this for serious buyers.
- **Quality control:** For the first 2–3 orders from any new supplier, arrange third-party QC inspection at the factory before shipment (Alibaba Inspection or Bureau Veritas).

Document maintained by Clawson. Update as supplier relationships develop.